

Your fixes are real — but they landed in the tokens, *not the pages.*

Legal wiring and nav focus states are genuinely done. The contrast lift was made in the token file and never reaches the chapters that actually had the problem. And the headline finding is unchanged: a superb homepage over a placeholder site.

SCOPE · 13U WORKING TREE VS. FIRST REVIEW

METHOD · RE-AUDIT OF SOURCE, TOKENS & ROUTE COMPOSITION

STATUS · 2 VERIFIED, 1 PARTIAL, 1 OPEN, 1 UNCHANGED

AUDIT VERDICT

You are right that the gap is **not more libraries**. But it is also not only photography. Four finishing defects are still open, none of them require a dependency: the contrast fix doesn't reach the page, the brand logo is a filtered JPEG, the first viewport shows two identical primary CTAs, and the locked typeface still isn't shipped.

01 Your five claims, checked

CLAIM	STATUS
Legal links fixed <code>content/navigation.ts:41-45</code> now points to <code>/privacy</code> , <code>/terms</code> , <code>/accessibility</code> ; all three routes exist.	VERIFIED
Nav accessibility improved <code>SiteHeader.module.css:98,104,109</code> adds <code>focus-visible</code> to nav link, CTA and menu toggle.	VERIFIED
Weak contrast fixed Token lifted at <code>tokens.css:12</code> (<code>#8a8780</code> → <code>#a8a49a</code>) — but the homepage chapters never consume that token. 31 hardcoded low-alpha inks remain, unchanged.	PARTIAL
Placeholders until photography Confirmed — 38 <code><MediaPlaceholder></code> mounts still render across ~30 routes. Home is the only page with real assets.	AS STATED
CMS / SSR not needed yet Next App Router is already SSR/SSG; deferring the CMS is correct.	VERIFIED

02 Why the contrast fix is only half-real

The token change is correct, but it addresses the wrong layer. The chapters that carried the worst contrast don't use `--color-fg-muted` — each one declares a private palette and paints with raw alpha values. Lifting the token leaves every one of these

untouched, so a visitor sees no change on the page.

```
styles/home/CreateBuildGrow.module.css:5 — body ink at 0.4 ; ticks at 0.22 (line 187)
```

```
styles/home/FeaturedWork.module.css:174,226 — index 0.3 , meta 0.35
```

```
styles/home/BrandWorldview.module.css:196 — footer note 0.28
```

```
styles/home/HomeHero.module.css:309,336 — brand whisper 0.28 , secondary CTA 0.38
```

```
SolutionsOverview :128 , PerspectivePreview :114 , ProcessOverview :55 , CollectivePreview :74 — same pattern
```

The same root cause from the first review: the design system exists but the components bypass it. Fix the source of truth and these 31 values resolve themselves; patch them by hand and they will drift again.

03 Still open from the first review

◆ The colour system is still not a system

`#e8c56a` is now hardcoded in 28 places — including the new motion kit. The declared token `--color-gold: #d4b57a` is still used zero times, and eleven files still declare their own `--gold`. The drift has grown, not shrunk.

◆ The logo is still a filtered JPEG

`SiteHeader.module.css:54-61` inverts a black-on-white JPEG with `mix-blend-mode: screen`. The brand README explicitly asks for an SVG master and says not to redraw the mark in CSS. A crisp white SVG is a five-minute asset that removes a permanent quality risk.

- ◆ **Two primary “Start a Project” CTAs in the first viewport**

`SiteHeader.tsx:84` and the hero floor CTA carry the same label, same action, both solid, visible together on desktop. One action, one primary entry point.

- ◆ **The locked display face still isn’t shipped**

`public/fonts/*` contains no font files. The site renders the Newsreader proxy while the docs call Tiempos Headline “LOCKED.” Either license it or commit to the proxy — but stop describing it as locked.

- ◆ **Page titles still break by word count**

`PageHero.tsx:90-96` halves the title at the midpoint word, and `PageHero.module.css:82` caps it at `12ch` with no balance. This is the setup for an orphaned final line.

04 New observations

- ◆ **The legal pages are honest placeholders — keep them that way**

Privacy and Terms contain real plain-language copy that openly says a full policy will replace it once counsel approves. That is the right approach — just don’t treat them as launch-ready, and keep them out of any paid or press push until the text is final.

- ◆ **The “fixed” state is uncommitted**

The working tree is **60 files changed / +3628 lines** with **31 untracked files** since the last commit. None of the improvements you cited are in version control, so they aren’t reproducible, reviewable, or handoff-safe. Commit before the next change.

05 What to do next

Nothing here needs a new dependency. Do these in order, smallest first — the contrast and colour work is one focused pass each.

01 Commit the working tree

Protect the fixes you already made before touching anything else. 60 files are one bad save away from being lost. **5 MIN**

02 Make the colour system real

Pick one gold (the shipped `#e8c56a` is the de-facto answer), bind it in `tokens.css`, and collapse the eleven local palettes into it. This resolves the contrast issue and the drift in the same pass. **ONE PASS**

03 Lift the chapter inks to AA

Sweep the 31 hardcoded alphas in `styles/home` to a 0.62–0.7 floor for body/interactive text; leave hairlines faint. Re-check the dark sections together.

ONE PASS

04 Ship a white SVG logo

Delete the filter/blend hack in the header and in `BrandLogo`.

05 Resolve the first-viewport CTA

Keep one solid primary; demote the other to a text or ghost link.

06 Then prove the content standard on two routes

Real photography on **Work** and **Collective / Leadership**, plus founder names and verified NAP once approved. Two real pages change the site's perceived completeness far more than finishing all thirty.

`styles/**` and `app/**` ; the git figures are from the working tree in the linked project.

Static design audit — no live render or interaction pass was performed.